OFFICIAL TECHNICAL STATUS REPORT

Brief! - accounts, invitations, and a closed board in production

Applications 2.4.0, 2.5.0 and 2.6.0 | Report v7 | Email, invitation links, an independent review, a Help Center

Project	Brief! - a message board where every post fits in 255 characters. Live at https://briefmessage.net.
Author	Ambroise Lumanikio (OneTechly, LLC)
Versions covered	2.4.0 (email on accounts, closed board), 2.5.0 (invitation links, account deletion, Terms and Privacy), 2.6.0 (Help Center, delivered with this report).
Report	OTSR v7 | October 21, 2026 | follows OTSR v6 (October 11, 2026)
Overall status	**2.5.0 runs in production** as a closed, invitation-only board run by AmbroLum, with mail sent through Resend. Its real test run passed 332 of 332. An independent review found one serious defect before release; it was fixed and covered by a test. **2.6.0 is built and checked**; its real run and deployment are the next step.
Most important open item	**The free Render database expires on November 10.** Move to paid plans before then (Section 9, item 1).

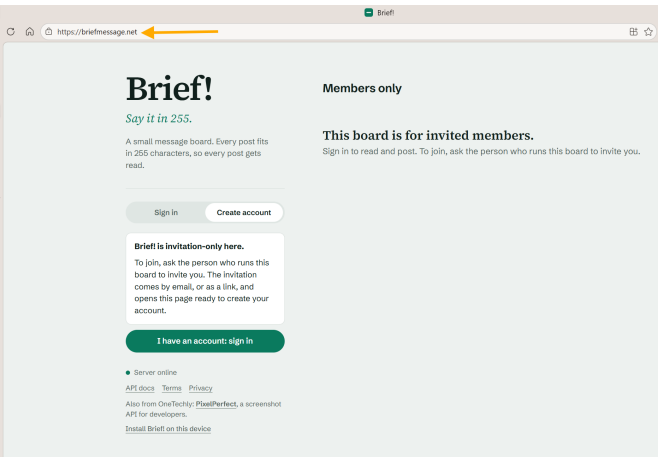
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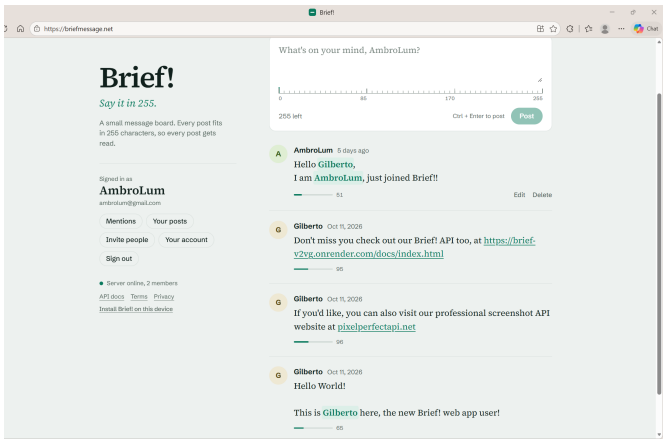
1. Summary

OTSR v6 ended with the site live and open to anyone, and with release 2.4 named as the one that would close that door. In the ten days since, three releases were written: two are in production and the third is ready.

Item	At OTSR v6 (Oct 11)	Now (Oct 21)	Status
Who can create an account	Anyone who finds the address	Only a person the board owner invites, by email or by link	DONE
Who can read	Anyone	Members only; visitors see "This board is for invited members"	DONE
Email on accounts	None	Confirmed through a mailed link; password reset by mail; sent through Resend from hello@briefmessage.net	LIVE
Leaving	No way to delete an account	"Your account": deletes the account and every post it wrote, with the password	LIVE
Terms and Privacy	None	Published; read and accepted by the author on October 20	DONE
Help Center	None	Six articles, including pricing (free during early access) and the refund policy (2.6.0)	BUILT
Automated tests	207	**333** (2.6.0); 332 of 332 in the author's real run of 2.5.0	PASS
Independent review	Never done	Done for 2.5.0; one high, two medium and several low findings, all fixed or recorded	DONE
Hosting plan	Free web service and free database	Unchanged; the database's free period ends November 10	OPEN



briefmessage.net to a visitor, October 20: the board is closed, and Create account explains how to join. Screenshot by the author.



The owner signed in, October 20: Invite people and Your account in the rail; the posts of October 11 kept through two upgrades. Screenshot by the author.

2. Decisions Recorded

#	Decision	Outcome	Decided by, when
1	Mail provider	Resend, free plan, account in the author's name; domain briefmessage.net verified there; sender hello@briefmessage.net	Author, Oct 11-12
2	Web app folder	frontend renamed frontend-spring (2.4)	Author, Oct 11
3	How newcomers join	**Invitation links** sent by the board owner replace the shared invitation code of 2.4. The code is dropped entirely.	Author, Oct 15
4	Who runs the board	AmbroLum, through the setting BRIEF_OWNER_USERNAME	Author's live account; Oct 16
5	Joining step	A full "Check your email" step while a new address waits for confirmation, modelled on Resend's own sign-up	Author's idea, Oct 15
6	An independent review before strangers join	Run for 2.5.0 on October 16 by a reviewer that had not seen the work	Author, Oct 16
7	Terms of use and Privacy notice	Read and accepted as published	Author, Oct 20
8	Tests on the author's computer never send mail	No Resend key locally; mails are written to the PowerShell window	Author, Oct 20
9	Pricing	**Free during early access.** No prices published yet; paid plans announced at least 30 days ahead, never charged without the member choosing	Author, Oct 21
10	Scope of 2.6	Help Center only, keeping one milestone per release. Notifications to a closed app and longer sessions move to 2.7	Author, Oct 21

3. What Each Release Did

2.4.0 - accounts become real (milestone M3a)

- An email address on every new account (strict mode), unique, shown to nobody but its owner. Confirmed through a link good once for 24 hours; until then the member reads but does not post.
- Password reset through a link good once for one hour; setting the new password ends every session (a token generation number on the account, checked on every request).
- Only a SHA-256 hash of each link's secret is stored. Mail sent through Resend's HTTPS API, never failing the member's request.
- A closed board, then by a shared invitation code (BRIEF_INVITE_CODE). Fixes from OTSR v6: the rate limiter's costly clean-up, the doubled password message, the .gitignore that let a database file through.
- Render deploys only after every CI job passes (`autoDeployTrigger: checksPass`). Tests: 303.

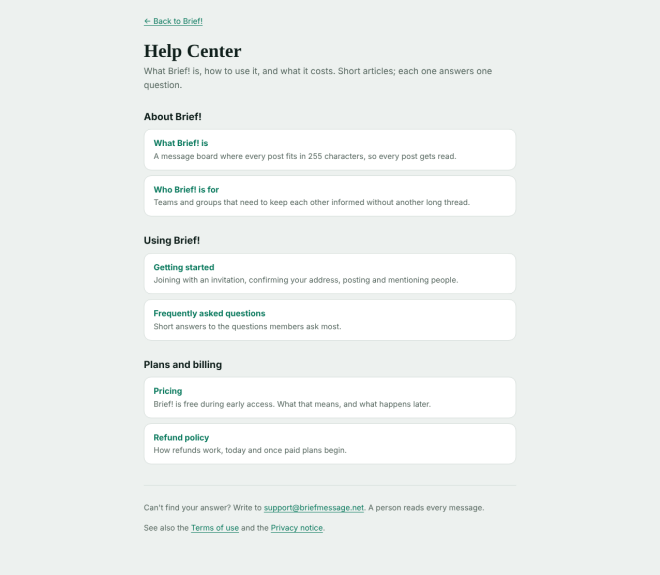
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2.5.0 - joining becomes professional

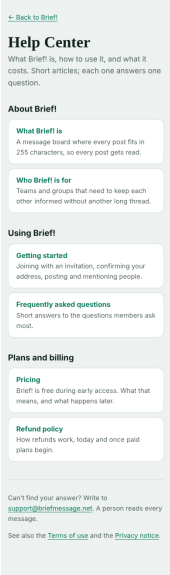
- Invitation links: by email (the invitee's address is fixed and starts confirmed) or as a link to pass on (the invitee confirms an address). One use each, 7 days, at most 50 a day, withdrawable.
- Visitors without an invitation see a clear explanation in place of a form field asking for a code.
- Account deletion with the password: the account and its posts go at once. The owner's account cannot be deleted.
- Terms of use and Privacy notice. Migration `V4__invitations.sql`. Tests: 332.

2.6.0 - Help Center (delivered with this report)

- Help beside Privacy in the rail opens /help/index.html: What Brief! is, Who Brief! is for, Getting started, FAQ, Pricing, Refund policy.
- Plain pages in the style of Terms and Privacy, public on a closed board, light and dark, readable on a phone. They describe only what exists today.
- No change to the Java code or the API; no new Render setting. Tests: 333.



The Help Center of 2.6.0 on a desktop, from the browser checks.



The same page at phone width.

4. Verification Record

Real runs on the author's computer (Java 17.0.11, Maven Wrapper)

Release	Date	Result	Status
2.4.0	October 12	**Tests run: 303, Failures: 0, Errors: 0**, BUILD SUCCESS	**PASS**
2.5.0 (as revised after the review)	October 16, 19:54	**Tests run: 332, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0**, BUILD SUCCESS in 1 min 07 s	**PASS**
2.5.0, the application itself	October 16, 20:34	Started with Spring Boot 3.3.5; Flyway applied V1 to V4 to a new H2 file; the web app served at localhost:8080	**PASS**
2.6.0	-	Expected: Tests run: 333	**PENDING**

Track record of the method: eight releases written without the real framework, eight first real runs with zero failures (82, 133, 149, 207, 303 and 332 tests for the Spring Boot releases).

Checks in the build environment

Check	2.4.0	2.5.0	2.6.0
All tests on the stand-in for Spring, H2 and PostgreSQL 16	303	332	333
Database upgrade from the previous release, PostgreSQL and H2	V3	V4	none needed
Deployment rehearsed with Render's settings, mail to a local stand-in for Resend	Yes	Yes	not needed
Browser checks (Chromium): new / repeated from earlier releases	new checks + 56	33 + 56 + 10	17 + 33 + 56 + 10
Deliberate bugs put into the new code and caught by the tests	-	38 of 39, then 39 of 39	a removed article is caught
Independent review	No	**Yes** (Section 5)	No (no Java change)

The stand-in itself improved. After the review, @Transactional methods in the stand-in run in real database transactions (commit, or roll back on an exception), so that a test of simultaneous registrations means the same there as under Spring. The decisive UPDATE was also tried by hand on PostgreSQL 16 and H2: of two simultaneous transactions, the second changed 0 rows.

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5. The Independent Review of 2.5.0

On October 16, before 2.5.0 was handed over, a separate reviewer that had not seen how it was built read the code against a list: joining without an invitation, using one twice, inviting or withdrawing as someone else, deleting another member's account, what the database keeps when an account goes, and whether the Terms and Privacy pages say what the code does.

Finding	Severity	Fix	Status
One link passed on could admit several people. The check "is this invitation unused?" and the write "it is used now" were two steps; inside a transaction Hibernate answered the first from memory, so registrations sent at the same moment all passed.	HIGH	One UPDATE ... where used_at is null and expires_at > now; the database lets exactly one through. New test: six registrations with one link at once admit one. It failed against the old code every time.	FIXED
The owner's username could be registered by a stranger on an open board before the owner's account existed.	MEDIUM	That name can never be registered.	FIXED
A deleted member's address stayed in the invitation they joined with, though the Privacy notice says it goes.	MEDIUM	That invitation is deleted with the account.	FIXED
Links from a former owner kept working; unused invitations were kept forever; the Terms omitted the owner's exception; two unclear messages in the app.	LOW	All five fixed; unused invitations are deleted 30 days after they expire, and the Privacy notice says so.	FIXED
An account deleted while the same member posts at that instant can fail with "try again"; the Javalin edition serves a Terms page promising deletion it cannot do.	LOW	Recorded, not changed.	ACCEPTED

What the review was worth

The serious finding was invisible to every test that existed: each request on its own behaved correctly. It took a reader asking "what if two arrive together?". Recommended from now on: a second, independent review for every change that touches sign-up, payment or deletion.

6. Deployment Record

When (EDT)	Event	Result
Oct 15, evening	First push of 2.4.0	**Deploy failed:** `BRIEF_MAIL_FROM must name the sender`. The previous release kept running.
Oct 15, by 21:55	BRIEF_MAIL_FROM and BRIEF_PUBLIC_URL added by hand; 2.4.0 deployed	Board closed by code; first confirmation mail delivered through Resend; AmbroLum confirmed and posted
Oct 19, 20:55	BRIEF_BOARD=closed and BRIEF_OWNER_USERNAME=AmbroLum added; 2.5.0 pushed	Built in 20 s; started in 112 s

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When (EDT)	Event	Result
Oct 19, 20:57	`Migrating schema "public" to version "4 - invitations"`	Applied in 0.3 s; existing accounts and posts kept
Oct 19, 20:58	`Board: closed. Owner: AmbroLum. Mail: sent through Resend, from Brief! .`	"Your service is live"
Oct 20	BRIEF_INVITE_CODE marked for deletion in the dashboard	No longer read by 2.5; saving the change is to be confirmed

Why the October 15 deploy failed

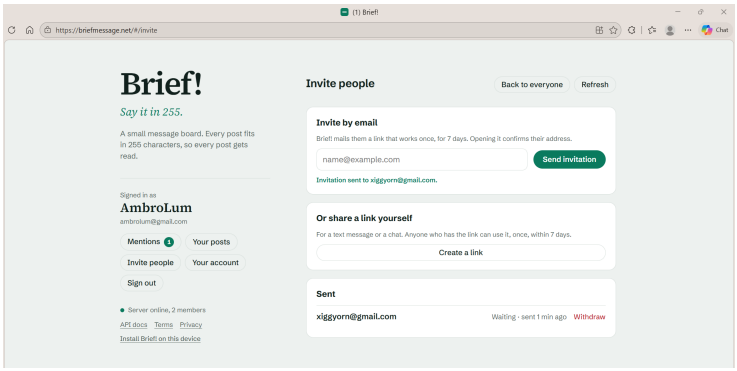
render.yaml of 2.4.0 set BRIEF_MAIL_FROM and BRIEF_PUBLIC_URL, and the instructions assumed Render would apply them. **Render applies render.yaml only when a Blueprint is first created**; it does not add new variables to an existing service. 2.4.0 refused to start without a sender, by design, and Render kept the previous release running, also by design. Since 2.5, render.yaml, the README and every "Before you deploy" section say plainly which variables must be added by hand, and in what order.

7. Verified Live on briefmessage.net

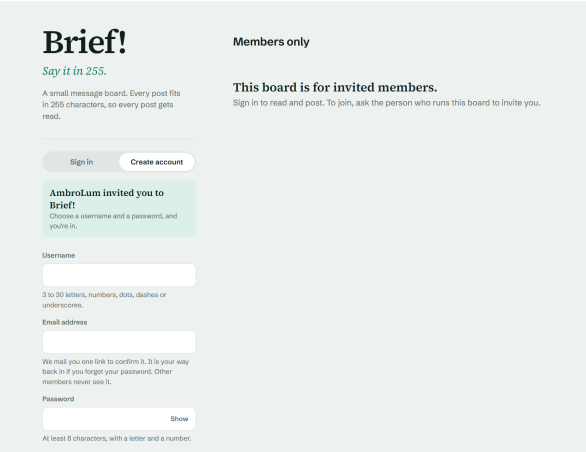
All by the author, on the production site, with real mailboxes.

Date	What was done	What happened	
Oct 15	Confirmation mail for AmbroLum	Arrived in Gmail's inbox, not spam; the link confirmed the address; posting worked	**PASS**
Oct 20	Forgot password for AmbroLum	Mail arrived in about a minute; new password set; signed in with every old post in place	**PASS**
Oct 20	A wrong password	"That username and password don't match", without saying which was wrong	**PASS**
Oct 20	An old, used confirmation link	Refused with a clear message; no session created by the link	**PASS**
Oct 20	Gilberto (account from October 11) adds an address	Confirmation mail delivered from hello@briefmessage.net	**PASS**
Oct 20	Mentions both ways	Highlighted in posts, counted under Mentions and in the browser tab title	**PASS**
Oct 20	Invite by email to a second address	"Invitation sent"; listed as Waiting with Withdraw. Arrival of the mail not yet seen	**PARTLY**
Oct 20-21	Create a link, copy it, open it	"AmbroLum invited you to Brief!" with the form ready; asks for an address, as designed	**PASS**
-	Finish a sign-up through each kind of invitation; Withdraw	Not yet done	**OPEN**

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Invite people on the live site, October 20. Screenshot by the author.



The page a shared invitation link opens, October 21. Screenshot by the author.

Why Gilberto can still post. The invitation controls the creation of new accounts. Members from before 2.4 keep their access and may post without an address until they add one; once an address is added, posting waits for its confirmation. One side effect observed: once an address belongs to a member, an invitation mailed to it can no longer create an account (one address, one account).

8. Defects Found and Lessons

#	Defect or mistake	Found by	Fix	Lesson
1	**Invitation link usable several times at once** (2.5.0, before release)	Independent review	Single conditional UPDATE; concurrency test	Test what happens when two requests arrive together.
2	2.4.0 deploy failed: two variables assumed to come from render.yaml	Render log, Oct 15	Added by hand; documents corrected	Know when a configuration file is applied, not only what it says.
3	A WARN about BRIEF_INVITE_CODE was announced for the 2.5.0 deploy; it does not appear when BRIEF_BOARD is set first	Author's log	Explained; the absence is correct	Predict from the code, not from memory of it.
4	A "git rm" command was referred to that had never been given	Author	Replaced by one PowerShell command that keeps only the current web app files	Give every command in full, every time.
5	Tests were run in the unpacked copy; the repository's web app files had been deleted and not yet replaced	Reading the author's "dir" output	robocopy into the repository before committing	Check the files in the folder that will be pushed.
6	The phone showed the 2.4 page after 2.5 was live	Author's screenshot	None needed: taken before the deploy; the app keeps a copy for slow starts	Note when a screenshot was taken.
7	The message for an old confirmation link says "Sign in to have a new one sent" to a member already signed in and confirmed	Author's screenshot	Planned for 2.7: "Your address is already confirmed."	Read each message in every state it can appear in.

9. Open Items

#	Item	Effect	Priority
1	Free Render database expires on **November 10**; no backups; the service sleeps when idle and starts in about two minutes	Data deleted after a 14-day grace period; slow first visits	HIGH
2	2.6.0: real run (expect 333), push, check the Help link on briefmessage.net	The Help Center is not live yet	NEXT
3	Finish the live invitation tests: one sign-up through an emailed invitation (to an address no member uses), one through a link, one Withdraw	Both flows verified only up to the form	MEDIUM
4	Find the invitation mailed to xiggyorn@gmail.com (Updates, Promotions, Spam) or check it in Resend's dashboard	Delivery of invitation mails not yet seen	MEDIUM
5	Gilberto's address is waiting for confirmation, so he cannot post until he sends the link again and opens it	Expected behaviour, but a test account is blocked	LOW

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#	Item	Effect	Priority
6	Save the deletion of BRIEF_INVITE_CODE in Render	Clutter only; 2.5 ignores it	LOW
7	Not yet observed: the visitor's address header (DEBUG check); the database's Networking page; Cloudflare auto-renew	Unconfirmed, not known to be wrong	LOW
8	Reinstall the phone app from briefmessage.net if it was installed from the computer's local address	It would open the local copy	LOW

10. What Comes Next

The plan is Launch Roadmap v4 (Brief_Launch_Roadmap_v4.pdf), issued with this report. In outline:

Step	Contents	State
M0 to M2	Domain, deployable build, briefmessage.net over HTTPS	DONE
M3a (2.4)	Email on accounts, confirmation, password reset, closed board	DONE
M3b (2.5)	Invitation links, account deletion, Terms and Privacy	DONE
M3c (2.6)	Help Center: what Brief! is, pricing, FAQ, refunds	BUILT
Paid plans	Render web service and database on paid plans, before November 10	NEXT
M3d (2.7)	Mentions that reach a closed app (push notifications), longer sessions, the confirmed-address message	NEXT
Pilot	One invited team uses the board for two weeks	NEXT
M4 and later	Private boards per team, attachments, payment with Stripe, public launch	LATER

> **Bottom line**
>
> Ten days ago anyone could register on briefmessage.net. Today only invited people can, their addresses are confirmed, they can leave and take their posts with them, and the rules are written down. The one defect that could have let uninvited people in was found by review, not by a stranger. The next deadline is a date, not a feature: November 10.

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